VEHICLE → BATTERY DATA · 15 AUGUST 2026

Battery Fitment Audit

Where our battery recommendation data stands after this week's clean-up: how many vehicles we can advise on, how confident we are in each answer, and what still needs work.

This covers the **underlying reference data** — which battery suits which vehicle. It does not show, ultimately, how the system matches a customer's vehicle to a battery; that step is separate, and is described on the final pages.

VEHICLES COVERED	MAKES	YEARS	OEM FITMENT
20,506	**33**	**2000–26**	**63%**
one entry per model and year	2,066 models	nothing older is published	12,957 matched to Exide's own guide

What we mean by a "fitment"

A fitment is one line that says: *for this make, this model, this year, fit this battery*. Our list holds 20,506 of them. When a customer walks in with a 2018 Toyota, the system looks up that line and names the battery.

The workbook accompanying this report contains every one of those lines, plus the manufacturer's own guide on a separate sheet so any single answer can be checked against its source.

The checks we run before publishing

Nine automatic checks run over the whole list. Each one exists because that particular mistake has appeared in our data before — so this is really a list of past problems, each with a guard now standing over it. All nine pass.

PASS	Every battery we recommend is a real product we actually stock	0 missing
PASS	The battery type we print matches the battery we name	0 mismatched

PASS	Japanese cars get Japanese-standard batteries, European cars European	0 wrong
PASS	No battery is wildly too big or too small for the engine	76% squarely typical
PASS	Nothing older than the year 2000 is published	earliest 2000
PASS	Every vehicle on the list exists on our master vehicle list	0 strays
PASS	No vehicle appears twice with two different answers	all unique
PASS	No car is dated before the technology in its name existed	0 anachronisms
PASS	Coverage is recorded for every make, so gaps are visible	33 makes

Do our two lists agree with each other?

We keep two lists. The **master vehicle list** records every vehicle in the market and its details — engine size, fuel. The **fitment list** is built from it and adds the battery we recommend, copying those details across as it goes.

Because they are copies, they can fall out of step, and they had: on **265 vehicles** the fitment list still held details the master list had since corrected. A Land Rover Defender was recorded as petrol on one list and diesel on the other. That matters because the system serving customers reads the *master* list, so the guide was describing cars differently from how they were actually being handled — and nothing on the page told you which of the two to believe.

All 265 have been brought back into line. We then ran seven checks looking for any remaining disagreement between the two lists. Each one counts problems found, so **zero is the result we want**:

NONE	Fitments for a vehicle that is not on the master list	0 found
NONE	Vehicles appearing as both published and held back	0 found
NONE	Batteries named that are not in our product catalogue	0 found
NONE	Printed capacity differing from the battery's real capacity	0 found
NONE	Printed battery type differing from the battery's real type	0 found

NONE	Engine size differing from the master list	0 found
NONE	Fuel type differing from the master list	0 found

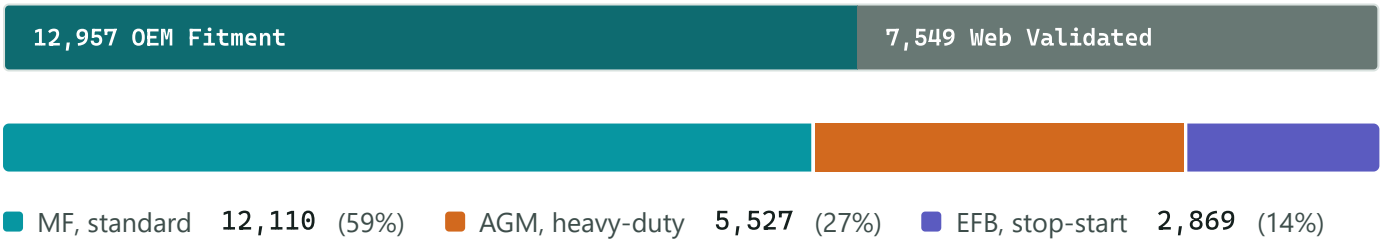
In short: every vehicle we publish exists, every battery we name is one we sell, and the two lists now describe each car identically.

OEM Fitment and Web Validated

Every entry is one of two kinds. An **OEM Fitment** takes the battery size straight from Exide's official global fitment guide. Exide is an original-equipment battery manufacturer — it supplies batteries to vehicle makers for fitting on the production line — so its guide is an authoritative statement about its own product, and the strongest evidence we have.

Where that guide does not cover a vehicle, the entry is **Web Validated**: looked up online, then checked against our own sizing rules before we accept it.

Capacity is the only figure we ever take from the internet. The battery type and the product we finally name are decided by our own rules against what we actually stock — which is why those two can no longer disagree, the fault raised on the previous guide.



Battery type across all 20,506 vehicles. Roughly one vehicle in four now calls for AGM and one in seven for EFB, which matters for what we hold in stock: the standard MF battery alone covers well under two thirds of the cars we advise on.

Wherever Exide's guide disagreed with our own sizing rules, we took Exide as correct — every time. Our rules tend to over-size sports and hybrid cars: they suggest roughly 90Ah for a Nissan GT-R and a Toyota Mirai, while Exide lists 45Ah for both.

How much of each make we cover

Coverage is the share of that make's vehicles from 2000 onward that we can now advise on. *OEM Fitment* is the share of those answers matched to Exide's own guide rather than validated from the web. Longer bars are better; red marks the weakest. *Exide covers* is the plain count behind that percentage — how many of our vehicles for that make appear in Exide's guide at all.

A low OEM Fitment figure is usually not our shortfall — it means Exide's guide holds little or nothing for that make. Maruti Suzuki does not appear in it at all, so every Maruti answer has to be web validated no matter how much work we put in. Hino sits at 4% for the same reason: 190 entries against 417 vehicles on our list. Read that column as *how much help Exide's guide gave us*, not as a score.

MAKE	VEHICLES	COVERAGE	EXIDE COVERS	OEM FITMENT
Land Rover	4,271	68%	4,199	98%
Toyota	2,167	82%	953	44%
Audi	1,315	65%	937	71%
Nissan	1,165	70%	461	40%
Peugeot	1,061	86%	596	56%
Daihatsu	883	74%	415	47%
Mazda	883	81%	304	34%
Maruti Suzuki	867	79%	0	0%
Volkswagen	844	95%	626	74%
Renault	766	68%	636	83%
Honda	639	76%	81	13%
Mercedes	628	51%	524	83%
BMW	608	60%	499	82%
Hyundai	575	58%	418	73%
Subaru	508	95%	295	58%
Porsche	386	61%	336	87%
Hino	357	86%	16	4%
Fiat	329	87%	251	76%
Mitsubishi	324	36%	136	42%
Volvo	298	73%	298	100%
Suzuki	277	65%	128	46%

MAKE	VEHICLES	COVERAGE	EXIDE COVERS	OEM FITMENT
Chevrolet	271	90%	192	71%
Jeep	240	43%	183	76%
Lexus	165	38%	107	65%
Isuzu	163	57%	50	31%
Ford	154	90%	89	58%
Kia	133	91%	76	57%
Jaguar	97	30%	83	86%
Dodge	42	25%	42	100%
Chery	33	31%	26	79%
Haval	33	87%	0	0%
FAW	21	100%	0	0%
Great Wall	3	100%	0	0%

Twelve further makes have no coverage — Scania (369 vehicles), Mini (274), Bentley (173), Vauxhall (101), Nissan Diesel/UD (88), Rolls-Royce (62), MAN and Eicher (33 each), Tata (30), SAIC (8), Dongfeng and Fuso (1 each). These are heavy haulage fleets and rare luxury marques that barely exist on Kenyan roads and are not part of the retail trade we serve. We do not intend to chase them: about 4% of the vehicle list, and close to none of the demand.

Exide's global fitment guide

Our strongest answers rest on Exide's own official fitment guide. Exide is an original-equipment battery manufacturer, supplying batteries to vehicle makers for fitting on the production line, and it publishes a global guide stating which of its batteries belongs in which vehicle. That is a manufacturer speaking about its own product, which is why we treat it as authoritative and let it override our internal sizing rules wherever the two disagree.

It ships as the third sheet of the workbook, so any single recommendation can be traced back to the line in the guide that supports it.

The guide is global, so most of it does not apply to us: 89,424 entries across 76 makes, covering marques we do not sell — MAN, Citroën, Opel, Skoda — and reaching back well before 2000. The figures below are the portion that applies to the makes and years we actually trade in.

ENTRIES WE CAN USE	OUR MAKES IT COVERS	MODELS	MATCHED BY US
43,332	**31**	**14,893**	**63%**
of 89,424 in the full guide	of the 33 we sell for	38,721 passenger · 4,611 commercial	12,957 of our entries tied to it

Matching our vehicle names to Exide's is harder than it sounds, and this week we found four faults in how we were doing it. The guide writes every Volkswagen as “VW”, misspells Mercedes-Benz as “MERCEDEZ-BENZ” on 5,169 entries, and names Lexus models in two letters — CT, ES, RX; our own records prefix every Jeep with “CHRYSLER”. Each broke the matching silently. Volkswagen was being reported as having no Exide backing whatsoever when the guide in fact holds 6,151 Volkswagen entries. Correcting all four lifted our OEM Fitment share from 58% to 63%, took Jeep and Lexus from nothing to 76% and 65%, and let us re-price 241 vehicles from Exide data that had never been visible to us.

How Japanese Wikipedia fixed our model years

A battery recommendation is only as good as the years attached to the car, and we had a serious problem there. Our records claimed the Toyota Land Cruiser had been on sale continuously since 1951, and that a Renault Lutecia ran from 1984 to 2025. Both are nonsense, and wrong years quietly produce wrong batteries.

The fix came from an unlikely place. Japanese Wikipedia documents Japanese cars far more rigorously than the English version does: it publishes a table for every individual generation of a model, with the exact months production started and stopped, and the manufacturer's own chassis codes. It is free to use, and it covers precisely the Japanese-import vehicles that make up most of the Kenyan fleet.

Why reading it was difficult

1. **The summary at the top of the page is the very thing that misled us**

   It gives the nameplate's entire history — “Land Cruiser, since 1951” — which is exactly the wrong answer. The useful figures sit further down in the per-generation tables, and had to be read out of the page's underlying markup rather than its readable text.

2. **Japanese dates, and a different calendar**

   Dates are written 1996年8月 rather than August 1996, and older pages use the Japanese imperial calendar — Shōwa, Heisei, Reiwa — which counts years from the start of each emperor's reign instead of from a fixed point.

3. **Two lookalike data boxes, one of them a trap**

   Pages carry a summary box and a per-generation box that look nearly identical. The summary box on the Land Cruiser page reads “1951 –” — the same wrong answer that began this whole investigation, simply in a different place. We had to teach the reader to ignore that box entirely.

4. **No two pages are laid out the same way**

   Some generations are numbered and some are not. The Land Cruiser's 70-series stopped and restarted production twice, so one heading holds three separate date ranges — and treating them as a single unbroken run would have deleted real, recent vehicles.

5. **Being turned away looks identical to finding nothing**

   Ask Wikipedia for pages too quickly and it politely refuses — and a refusal is easily mistaken for “this car has no data”, which is precisely how bad years entered our records in the first place. A refusal is now treated as an error that stops the run, never as an empty answer.

Working out *which* generation a given car belonged to was the last piece, and the answer turned out to be sitting in our own source file. The CRSP data carries a Japanese vehicle type-approval code for each car, and that code names the generation outright. We had been holding it all along without ever using it.

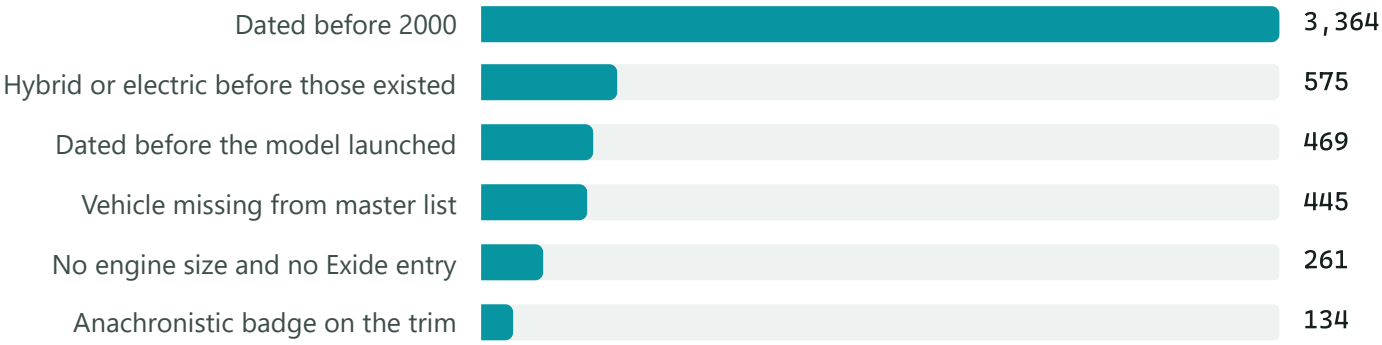


Wrong year records removed, by the evidence that caught them. Japanese Wikipedia found more than any other source — 6,314 of the 21,604 removed, just under a third — and it is the only one of the four that can say what a model's years actually *are* rather than only that the ones we held were impossible.

The result: the Renault Lutecia our records dated 1984–2025 is now correctly dated 2012–2019. A clean-up built on this work removed 7,185 impossible year records in a single pass — and tellingly, most were not the obviously ancient ones. They were entries that looked entirely reasonable, such as an Audi badged “30 TFSI” dated to 2006, years before Audi began using that name.

What we held back, and why

5,248 entries were kept out of the published list because we could not stand behind them. Nothing was thrown away — every one is stored with the reason it failed, and any batch can be restored if we later find it was sound.



Why each of the 5,248 held-back entries failed. Almost two thirds are simply older than the year 2000 — a deliberate cut-off rather than a fault. The remaining 1,884 are genuine data errors we caught and removed.

3,364 **Older than the year 2000**

Too old to source parts for reliably, so outside what we publish.

572 **A hybrid or electric car dated before those existed**

For example a Volvo listed as a hybrid in 2004. The car is real; the year is not.

463 **Dated before the model was launched**

Checked against the manufacturer's own production dates. The Porsche Cayenne Coupé appeared in our data from 2000, but it only went on sale in 2019.

445 **Vehicle missing from the master list**

Nothing to attach the recommendation to, so it cannot be trusted.

261 **No engine size and no manufacturer entry**

With neither, there is no way to check whether the battery size is sensible — so we do not publish it as fact.

134 **Anachronisms**

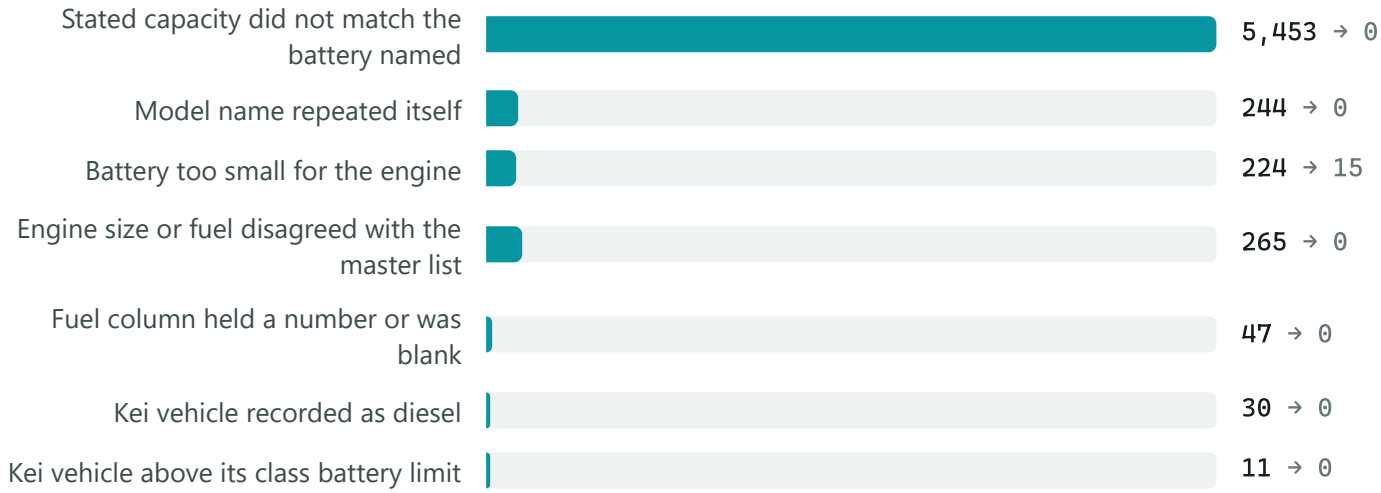
An anachronism is something appearing at the wrong point in history. A "TSI" badge on a 2001 Volkswagen is one: VW did not build TSI engines until 2005, so that year must be wrong. The same applies to badges like MHEV and PHEV.

9 **Before a launch date we set by hand**

Models the manufacturer's guide does not cover, so we dated them ourselves.

What we corrected this week

Each bar is a fault we found in the data and the number of vehicles it affected. The grey figure after the arrow is what remains today.



The fifteen still showing under “battery too small” are the Nissan GT-R and Toyota Mirai, where Exide genuinely specifies a small battery for a large engine — they are correct, not outstanding.

Separately, 5,248 entries were held back rather than corrected, and 241 vehicles were re-priced against Exide data that a name-matching fault had been hiding from us. Every change is recorded and can be reversed.

What still needs doing

Three things. None of them stops us publishing or presenting this, but all three are worth putting on a plan.

We cover two vehicles in every three

Coverage sits at 67% of vehicles from the year 2000 onward. Mitsubishi (36%), Jaguar (30%) and Dodge (25%) are the weakest of the makes we do cover, and twelve makes have nothing at all. Closing these needs more online lookups, and we buy those lookups in advance — so this is limited by budget rather than by effort.

Some model years still need checking by hand

We removed years that came before a model was launched. But a recent model can still carry wrong years in the middle of its range, and no automatic check catches that. The Dodge Hornet is a 2023 car, so the years we hold for it between 2010 and 2022 are wrong. This needs a person, and the sensible order is by how often customers actually search for the vehicle.

A handful of entries look odd but are correct

Fifteen vehicles have a small battery on a big engine — these are the Nissan GT-R and Toyota Mirai, and the makers really do fit a small battery to both. Seven keep an awkward-looking model name because tidying it would merge two genuinely different engines into one. Three vary in battery size across their own years and we have no engine size recorded to settle it.

What this report does not cover

Everything above describes the **reference data** — the list of which battery suits which vehicle, and how well evidenced each line of it is. That is the raw material. It is not the same thing as what happens when someone actually looks a vehicle up.

Between the customer and this data sits the matching step, and it is doing more work than the data alone implies. A customer does not type a row from our list; they type what they call their car. The system has to:

1. **Recognise the vehicle from an imperfect name**
   Spelling, spacing and local naming all vary — the same car may be entered a dozen ways. The system matches approximately rather than demanding an exact match, and reports how confident it is.

2. **Handle a year we do not hold**
   If the exact year is missing but nearby years are present, it can still answer from those, with lower stated confidence rather than a refusal.

3. **Answer for a vehicle absent from the list entirely**
   Where the vehicle is not covered at all, it falls back to engine size and fuel type to size a battery. This is why the 67% coverage figure above does not mean a third of customers get nothing.

4. **Apply rules the data does not carry**
   Whether the car has stop-start, and whether it takes a Japanese or European battery case, are decided at the moment of the lookup rather than stored per vehicle.

So a fault in the matching step could produce a wrong answer from perfectly good data, and equally a sound match will still be wrong if the underlying line is wrong. This report covers the second of those two only. Testing how the system behaves for a real customer — the accuracy of the answers it actually returns — is separate work, and worth doing on the back of this.

Keeping this current

This report is a snapshot, not a finished job. Nothing in the data stops it going out of date on its own, and the ways it does are predictable:

`Yearly`	**New model years arrive**	Every vehicle we already list gains another year, and genuinely new models appear. Without a refresh the guide simply stops at the year it was built — it will not look broken, it will just quietly go stale at the newest end, which is exactly where the sales are.
`On issue`	**Exide revises its fitment guide**	63% of our answers rest on that guide. A new edition changes what we can confirm, and may correct entries we are currently relying on. This is the single highest-value refresh of the four, because it needs no research budget — only reloading the file.
`As needed`	**New makes enter the market**	A make absent from our list returns nothing at the counter rather than a wrong answer, so this fails quietly. It is worth checking against what is actually being imported rather than waiting to be told.
`Budget`	**Coverage work is limited by prepaid lookups**	Extending coverage to the makes we do not yet reach needs online lookups that are bought in advance. Coverage is therefore constrained by budget rather than by effort, and cannot simply be scheduled.

The automated checks in this report run on every change, so a future update cannot silently reintroduce the faults described here. What they cannot do is notice that the data has stopped being refreshed at all.

Terms used in this report

OEM Fitment

OEM means "original equipment manufacturer" — a company whose product is fitted on the production line rather than sold afterwards as a replacement. Exide is one of these, for batteries. An OEM Fitment is a battery size taken straight from Exide's own global fitment guide, so it is the strongest evidence we have. 12,957 of our entries are backed this way.

Web Validated

Where Exide's guide does not cover a vehicle, we look the battery size up online and then check it against our own sizing rules before accepting it. 7,549 of our entries came this way. Less certain than an OEM Fitment, but checked rather than guessed.

Ah (amp-hours)

How much charge a battery holds — its size. A small hatchback takes around 35–45Ah; a large diesel SUV around 95–110Ah.

MF, AGM and EFB

The three battery types we sell. MF is the standard maintenance-free battery. AGM is the heavy-duty type for cars with a lot of electronics. EFB sits between them and suits cars whose engine switches off at traffic lights.

Japanese and European standards

Batteries come in two families of sizes and terminal layouts. Japanese and Korean cars take one; European and American cars take the other. Fitting the wrong family means the battery physically will not go in.

Anachronism

Something appearing at the wrong point in history — a badge or technology on a car built before that technology was invented. We use it as a signal that the year on the record is wrong.

Fitment

One line of advice: for this make, model and year, fit this battery.

Master vehicle list

Our record of every vehicle that exists in the market, independent of which battery suits it. Recommendations are built from it.

Measured against live data on `15 August 2026` `29` saved versions, every change reversible

Exide guide: `89,424` entries, `43,332` relevant